



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Hillsdale Academy

School Website: <https://academy.hillsdale.edu/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

I'm not yet seeing the actual "newly attached crawl data" (the JSON/JSONL with one record per school). Right now I only see the instructions and lexicon documents (e.g., the Six Essential Elements and the metadata schema), not the crawl output itself.

To produce the "complete classicality audit" you're asking for, I need the crawl dataset that contains, for each school, things like:

- slug, url, og_title, og_description
- classicality_category_1 ... classicality_category_6
- or at least the raw text snippets from the crawl that I can run the keyword analysis on.

Right now, I can't see any such crawl file (no .json, .jsonl, or similar with multiple school records).

Could you either:

1. Upload the crawl JSON/JSONL file, **or**
2. Confirm the filename if it's already uploaded (e.g., "crawl_data.jsonl", "schools_vector_store.jsonl", etc.), so I can target it explicitly with the file search tool?

Once I have that, I will:

1. For each school:
 - Extract its public text (titles, descriptions, curriculum pages if present in the record).
 - Run a **keyword audit per the Six Essential Elements** across the six categories, using the positive/negative lexicon (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, Socratic, scholé, wonder, chanting, project-based, experiential learning, etc.) as required.
 - Count positive vs. negative hits and estimate percent_positive and percent_coverage per category.
 - Assign a category rating: CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL.
2. Aggregate to an overall classicality_status for each school.
3. Produce the report in markdown with:
 - **Executive Summary TL;DR** at the top.
 - A section per school with the six categories, keyword tables, and ratings.
 - A **"What would move the needle"** section for every school that ends up SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - A final **ABSTRACT** summarizing the overall classifications and key insights across the six categories.

Please upload or point me to the crawl data file, and I'll run the full classicality audit.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.